



THE Two Gentlemen of Verona.

Actus primus, Scena prima.

Valentine : Protheus, and Speed.

Valentine.

Ease to perfwade, thy louing *Protheus*;
Home-keeping youthfull wits, euer homely wits,
Wer't not affection chaines thy tender dayes
To the sweet glances of thy honour'd Loue,
I rather would entreat thy company,
To see the wonders of the world abroad,
Then (liuing dully sluggardiz'd at home)
Weare out thy youth with chapeleffe idlenesse.
But since thou lou'st; loue still, and thrive therein,
Euen as I would, when I to lout begin.

Pro. Wilt thou be gone? Sweet *Valentine* ad ew,
Thinke on thy *Protheus*, when thou (hap'ly) seest
Some rare note-worthy obiekt in thy traualle.
With me partaker in thy happinesse,
When thou do'st meet good hap; and in thy danger,
(If euer danger doe enuiron thee)
Commend thy grievance to my holy prayers,
For I will be thy breade-f-man, *Valentine*.

Val. And on a lout, booke pray for my successe?

Pro. Vpon some booke I loue, I'll pray for thee.

Val. That's on some shallow *Storie* of deepe loue,
How yong *Leander* crost the *Hellefont*.

Pro. That's a deepe *Storie*, of a deeper loue,
For he was more then ouer-shoot in loue.

Val. 'Tis true; for you are ouer-bootes in loue,
And yet you neuer swom the *Hellefont*.

Pro. Ouert the Bootes? nay giue me not the Bootes.

Val. No, I will not; for it boots thee not.

Pro. What? (grones)

Val. To be in loue; where scorne is bought with
Coy looks, with hart-fere sighes; one fading moment
With twenty watchfull, weary, tedious nightes; (mirth,
If hap'ly won, perhaps a haplesse gain; if lost,
why then a grieuous labour won;
How euer: but a folly bought with wit,
Or else a wit, by folly vanquished.

Pro. So, by your circumstance, you call me foole.

Val. So, by your circumstance, I feare you'll proue.

Pro. 'Tis *Loue* you caull at, I am not *Loue*.

Val. *Loue* is your master, for he masters you;
And he that is so yoked by a foole,
Methinks should not be chronickd for wise.

Pro. Yet Writers say; as in the sweetest *Bud*,
The eating Canker dwels; so eating *Loue*
Inhabits in the finest wits of all.

Val. And Writers say; as the most forward *Bud*

Is eaten by the Canker ere it blow,
Euen so by *Loue*, the yong, and tender wit
Is turn'd to folly, blasting in the *Bud*,
Looing his verdure, euen in the prime,
And all the faire effects of future hopes.
But wherefore wasse I time to counsaile thee
That art a votary to fond desire?

Once more adieu: my Father at the Road
Expects my coming, there to see me ship'd.

Pro. And thither will I bring thee *Valentine*.

Val. Sweet *Protheus*, no: Now let vs take our leave;
To *Milaine* let me heare from thee by Letters
Of thy successe in loue; and what newes else
Betide here in absence of thy Friend;
And I likewise will visite thee with mine.

Pro. All happinesse bechance to thee in *Milaine*.

Val. As much to you at home; and so farewell. *Exit.*

Pro. He after Honour hunts, I after *Loue*;
He leaues his friends, to dignifie them more;
I loue my selfe, my friends, and all for loue;
Thou *Julia*, thou hast metamorphis'd me:

Made me neglect my Studies, loose my time;
Waste with good counsaile; set the world at nought;
Made Wit with musing, weaker; hart sick with thought.

Sp. Sir *Protheus*: 'saue you: saw you my Master?

Pro. But now he parted hence to embarque for *Milaine*.

Sp. Twenty to one then, he is ship'd already,
And I haue plaid the Sheepe in loosing him.

Pro. Indeede a Sheepe doth very often stray,
And if the Shepheard be awhile away.

Sp. You conclude that my Master is a Shepheard then,
and I Sheepe?

Pro. I doe.

Sp. Why then my hornes are his hornes, whether I
wake or sleepe.

Pro. A silly answer, and sitting well a Sheepe.

Sp. This proues me still a Sheepe.

Pro. True: I and thy Master a Sheepe.

Sp. Nay, that I can deny by a circumstance.

Pro. It shall goe hard but ile proue it by another.

Sp. The Shepheard seekes the Sheepe, and not the
Sheepe the Shepheard; but I seeke my Master, and my
Master seekes not me: therefore I am no Sheepe.

Pro. The Sheepe for fodder follow the Shepheard,
the Shepheard for foode followes not the Sheepe: thou
for wages followest thy Master, thy Master for wages
followes not thee: therefore thou art a Sheepe.

Sp. Such another proofe will make me cry ba.

Pro. But do'st thou heare: gull'st thou my Letter
to *Julia*?

Sp. I Sir: I (a lost-Mutton) gave your Letter to her (a lost-Mutton) and she (a lost-Mutton) gave me (a lost-Mutton) nothing for my labour.

Pro. Here's too small a Pasture for such flocks of Muttons. *Sp.* If the ground be over-charg'd, you were best strike her.

Pro. Nay, in that you are astray: 'twere best pound you.

Sp. Nay Sir, less than a pound shall serve me for carrying your Letter.

Pro. You mistake; I mean the pound, a Pinfold.

Sp. From a pound to a pin? fold it over and over, 'Tis threefold too little for carrying a letter to your lover Sir. But what said she?

Sp. I.

Pro. Nod-I, why that's noddy.

Sp. You mistooke Sir: I say she did nod; And you ask me if she did nod, and I say I.

Pro. And that set together is poddy.

Sp. Now you have taken the pains to set it together, take it for your pains.

Pro. No, no, you shall have it for bearing the letter.

Sp. Well, I perceive I must be faine to beare with you.

Pro. Why Sir, how doe you beare with me?

Sp. Marry Sir, the letter verry orderly, Having nothing but the word noddy for my pains.

Pro. Bestrew me, but you have a quicke wit.

Sp. And yet it cannot over-take your slow purse.

Pro. Come, come, open the matter in briefe; what said she.

Sp. Open your purse, that the money, and the matter may be both at once deliver'd.

Pro. Well Sir: here is for your pains: what said she?

Sp. Truly Sir, I thinke you'll hardly win her.

Pro. Why? couldst thou perceive so much from her?

Sp. Sir, I could perceive nothing at all from her.

No, not so much as a ducklet for delivering your letter: And being so hard to me, that brought your minde,

I feare she'll prove as hard to you in telling your minde. Give her no token but flowers, for she's as hard as Steele.

Pro. What said she, nothing?

Sp. No, not so much as take this for thy pains: (me) To testifie your bounty. I thank you, you have cester'd

In requital whereof, henceforth, carry your letters yourselfe; And for Sir, I'll commend you to my Master.

Pro. Go, go, be gone, to save your Ship from wrack, Which cannot perish having thee aboard.

Being desir'd to a drier death on shore: I must goe send some better Messenger.

I feare my Julia would not digne my lines, Receiving them from such a worthless poore.

Scena Secunda.

Enter Julia and Lucentio.

Jul. But say Lucentio (now we are alone) Wouldst thou have coust me to fall in love?

Luc. I Madam, so you humble not vnder fully.

Jul. Of all the fairest of Gentlemen, That every day we see to encounter me,

In thy opinion which is worthiest love?

Luc. Please you repeat their names, I'll say my minde, According to my shallow simple skill.

Jul. What thinkst thou of the fairest *Engelmore*?

Luc. As of a Knight, well-spoken, neat, and fine; But were I you, he neuer should be mine.

Jul. What thinkst thou of the rich *Mercutio*?

Luc. Well of his wealth; but of himselfe, so, so.

Jul. What thinkst thou of the gentle *Probus*?

Luc. Lord, Lord: to see what folly raigues in vs.

Jul. How now? what means this passion at his name?

Luc. Pardon deare Madam, 'tis a passing shame,

That I (a worthy body as I am)

Should censure thus on lovely Gentlemen.

Jul. Why not on *Probus*, as of all the rest?

Luc. I then thus: of many good, I thinke him best.

Jul. Your reason?

Luc. I have no other but a womans reason.

I thinke him so, because I thinke him so.

Jul. And wouldst thou have me cast my love on him?

Luc. I: if you thought your love nor cast away.

Jul. Why he, of all the rest, hath neuer touch'd me.

Luc. Yet he, of all the rest, I thinke best loves ye.

Jul. His little speaking shewes his love but small.

Luc. Fire that's closest kept, burnes most of all.

Jul. They doe not love, that doe not shew their love.

Luc. Oh, they love least, that let men know their love.

Jul. I would I knew his minde.

Luc. Peruse this paper Madam.

Jul. To Julia: say from whom?

Luc. That the Contents will shew.

Jul. Say, say: who gave it thee?

Luc. Sir *Valentine* page: I lent I think from *Probus*;

He would have given it you, but I being in the way,

Did in your name receive it: pardon the fault I pray.

Jul. Now (by my modesty) a goodly Broker?

Dare you presume to harbour wanton lines?

To whisper, and conspire against my youth?

Now trust me, 'tis an office of great worth.

And you an officer fit for the place:

There: take the paper: see it be return'd,

Or else returne no more into my sight.

Luc. To plead for love, deserves more fee, then hate.

Jul. Will ye be gon?

Luc. That you may ruminate; and, thus, I Exit.

Jul. And yet I would I had ore-look'd the Letter;

It were a shame to call her backe againe,

And pray her to a fault, for which I chide her.

What foole is she, that knowes I am a Maid;

And would not force the letter to my view?

Since Maides in modesty, say no, to their desires,

Which they would have the profligate construe, I,

Fie, fie: how wayward is this foolish love.

That (like a restless Babe) will scratch the Nurse,

And presently, all humbled kisse the Rod?

How churlishly, I chide *Lucentio* hence,

When willingly, I would have had her here.

How angrily I taught my brow to frowne,

When inward joy enforced my heart to smile.

My penance is, to call *Lucentio* backe,

And aske remission, for my folly past.

What love: *Lucentio*.

Luc. What would your Ladieship?

Jul. Is't neere dinner time?

Luc. I would it were.

That you might kill your somacke on your meat.

And not vpon your Maid.
Lu. What is it that you wish me not to do?
Tooke vp to gingerly?
Lu. Nothing.
Lu. Why didst thou stoop then?
Lu. To take a paper vp, that I let fall.
Lu. And is that paper nothing?
Lu. Nothing concerning me.
Lu. Then let it lye, for those that it concerns.
Lu. Madam, it will not lye where it consernes.
 Vnlesse it haue a falsc Interpreter.
Lu. Some loue of yours, hath writ to you in Rime.
Lu. That I might sing it (Madam) to a tune.
 Giue me a Nose, your Ladishipp can see.
Lu. As little by such toys, as may be possible.
 Best sing it to the tune of *Light O' Love*.
Lu. It is too heavy for so light a tune.
Lu. Heavy? belike it hath some burden then?
Lu. I: and melodious were it, would you sing it.
Lu. And why not you?
Lu. I cannot reach so high.
Lu. Let's see your Song.
 How now Minion?
Lu. Keepe tune there still, so you will sing it out.
 And yet me thinkes I do not like this tune.
Lu. You doe not?
Lu. No (Madam) tis too heauie.
Lu. You (Minion) are too fauic.
Lu. Nay, now you are too flat.
 And marre the concord, with too harsh a discent.
 There wanteth but a Meane to fill your Song.
Lu. The meane is dround with you vnsly base.
Lu. Indeede I bid the base for *Protheus*.
Lu. This babble shall not henceforth trouble me.
 Here is a coile with protestation.
 Goe, get you gone, and let the papers lye.
 You would be fingring them, to anger me.
Lu. She makes it strange, but she would be best pleas'd
 To be so angry with another Letter.
Lu. Nay, would I were so angry with the same.
 Oh hatefull hands, to teare such joining words.
 Inurious Waspes, to ferde on such sweet honey.
 And kill the Bees that geelde it, with your stings.
 He kisse each feuerall paper, for amends.
 Looke, here is writ, kinde *Julia*, vnkinde *Julia*.
 As in reuenge of thy ingratitude,
 I throw thy name against the bruizing Bones.
 Trampling contemptuously on the disdained.
 And here is writ, *Loue wounded Protheus*.
 Poore wounded name: my bosome, as a bed.
 Shall lodge thee till thy wound be thoroughly healed.
 And thus I fensch it with a soueraigne kisse.
 But twice, or thrice, was *Protheus* written downe.
 Be calme (good winde) blow not a word away.
 Till I haue found each letter, in the Letter.
 Except mine own name: That, some whilst, winde beare
 Vnto a ragged, stearefull hanging Rocke.
 And throw it thence into the raging Sea.
 Now, here in one line is his name, *Protheus*.
 Paere forlorne *Protheus*, pishionate *Protheus*.
 To the sweet *Julia*: that teare away.
 And yet I will not, fith so prettily.
 He couples it, to his compassing Names.
 Thus will I fold them, one vpon another.
 Now kisse, embrace, contend, doe what you will.
Lu. Madam: dinner is ready: and your father stayes.

Lu. Well, let vs goe.
Lu. What, shall these papers lye, like Tel-tales here?
Lu. If you respect them; best to take them vp.
Lu. Nay, I was taken vp, for laying them downe.
 Yet here they shall not lye, for catching cold.
Lu. I fee you haue a months minde to them.
Lu. I (Madam) you may say what fights you see.
 I fee things too, although you iudge I winke.
Lu. Come, come, wilt please you goe. *Exeunt.*

Scena Tertia.

Enter Antonio and Panthino, Protheus.

Ant. Tell me *Panthino*, what sad talke was that,
 Wherewith my brother held you in the Cloyster?
Pan. 'Twas of his Nephew *Protheus*, your Sonne.
Ant. Why? what of him?
Pan. He wonderd that your Lordship
 Would suffer him, to spend his youth at home,
 While other men, of slender reputation
 Put forth their Sonnes, to seeke preferment out.
 Some to the warres, to try their fortune there;
 Some, to discouer Islands farre away:
 Some, to the studious Vniuersities;
 For any, or for all these exercises,
 He said, that *Protheus*, your sonne, was meet;
 And did request me, to importune you
 To let him spend his time no more at home;
 Which would be great impeachment to his age,
 In hauing knowne no trauaile in his youth.
Ant. Nor need'st thou much importune me to that
 Whereon, this month I haue bin hammering,
 I haue consider'd well, his losse of time,
 And how he cannot be a perfect man,
 Not being tryed, and tutored in the world.
 Experience is by industry atchieu'd,
 And perfected by the swift course of time.
 Then tell me, whether were I best to lend him?
Pan. I thinke your Lordship is not ignorant
 How his companion, youthfull *Valentine*,
 Attends the Emperour in his royall Court.
Ant. I know it well. *(thither,*
Pan. 'Twere good, I thinke, your Lordship sent him
 There shall be practise Tilts, and Turnaments;
 Heare sweet discourse, conuerse with Noble men,
 And be in eye of every Exercise
 Worthy his youth, and noblenesse of birth.
Ant. I like thy counsaile: well hast thou aduis'd.
 And that thou maist perceiue how well I like it,
 The execution of it shall make knowne;
 Euen with the speediest expedition,
 I will dispatch him to the Emperours Court.
Pan. To morrow, may it please you, *Don Alphonse*,
 With other Gentlemen of good esteeme
 Are iourning, to salute the Emperour,
 And to commend their seruice to his will.
Ant. Good company: with them shall *Protheus* go:
 And in good time: now will we breake with him.
Pro. Sweet Loue, sweet lines, sweet life,
 Here is her hand, the agent of her heart;
 Here is her oath for loue, her honour paue;

O that our fathers would applaud our loves
To seal our happinesse with their consents.

Pro. Oh heavenly *Silvia*,

Ans. How now? What Letter are you reading there?

Pro. May't please your Lordship, tis a word or two
Of commendations sent from *Valentine*;
Deliver'd by a friend, that came from him.

Ans. Lend me the Letter: Let me see what newes.

Pro. There is no newes (my Lord) but that he writes
How happily he liues, how well-below'd,
And daily grieved by the Emperor;
Wishing me with him, partner of his fortune.

Ans. And how stand you affected to his wish?

Pro. As one relying on your Lordships will,
And not depending on his friendly wish.

Ans. My will is something forced with his wish:
Muse not that I thus suddenly proceed
For what I will, I will, and there an end:
I am resolu'd, that thou shalt spend some time
With *Valentine*, in the Emperors Court;
What maintenance he from his friends receiues,
Like exhibition thou shalt haue from me,
To morrow be in readiness, to goe,
Excuse it not: for I am peremptory.

Pro. My Lord I cannot be so soone provided,
Please you deliberate a day or two.

Ans. Look what thou want'st shall be sent after thee:
No more of stay: to morrow thou must goe;
Come on *Pantho*; you shall be employ'd,
To hasten on his Expedition.

Pro. Thus haue I stand the fire, for feare of burning,
And drench'd me in the sea, where I am drown'd.
I fear'd to shew my Father *Julius* Letter,
Least he should take exceptions to my loue,
And with the vantage of mine owne excuse
Hath he excepted most against my loue.
Oh, how this spring of loue resemblith
The vncertaine glory of an Aprill day,
Which now shewes all the beauty of the Sun,
And by and by a cloud takes all away.

Pan. Sir *Protheus*, your Fathers call's for you,
He is in haste, therefore I pray you go.

Pro. Why this it is: my heart accords thereto,
And yet a thousand times it answer's no.

Exeunt. Protheus.

Actus secundus: Scœna Prima.

Enter Valentine, Speed, Silvia.

Speed. Sir, your Gloue.

Val. Not mine: my Gloues are on.

Sp. Why then this may be yours: for this is but one.

Val. Ha? Let me see it, giue it me, it's mine:
Sweet Ornament, that deckes a thing diuine.

Ah Silvia, Silvia.

Speed. Madam *Silvia*: Madam *Silvia*.

Val. How now *Silvia*?

Speed. Shee is not within hearing Sir.

Val. Why sir, who had you call her?

Speed. Your worship fur, or else I mistooke.

Val. Well: you'll still be too forward.

Speed. And yet I was last chidden for being too slow.

Val. Goe to, sir, tell me do you know Madam *Silvia*?

Speed. Shee that your worship loues?

Val. Why, how know you that I am in loue?

Speed. Marry by these speciall marks: first, you haue
learn'd (like Sir *Protheus*) to wrath your Arm: like a
Male-content: to relish a Loue-song, like a
breast: to walke alone like one that had the pellence:
to sigh, like a Schoole-boy that had lost his *A, B, C*, to
weep like a yong wench that had buried her Grandam:
to fast, like one that takes diet: to watch, like one that
feares robbing: to speake pining, like a beggar in
Hallow-Masse: You were wont, when you laugh'd, to crow
like a cocke; when you walk'd, to walke in one of the
Lions: when you fasted, it was presently after dinner:
when you look'd sadly, it was for want of money: And
now you are Metamorphis'd with a Mistresse, that when
you look on you, I can hardly thinke you my Master.

Val. Are all these things recei'd in me?

Speed. They are all percei'd without ye.

Val. Without me? they can not.

Speed. Without you? Nay, that's certaine: for with-
out you were so simple, none else would: but you are
so without these follies, that these follies are within you,
and shine through you like the water in an Vrinall: that
not an eye that sees you, but is a Physician to comment
on your Malady.

Val. But tell me do'st thou know my Lady *Silvia*?

Speed. Shee that you gaze on, as the fitts or suppers?

Val. Hast thou obseru'd that? euen the I meane.

Speed. Why sir, I know her not.

Val. Do'st thou know her by my gazing on her, and
yet know'st her not?

Speed. Is she not hard-favour'd, sir?

Val. Not so faire (boy) as well fauour'd.

Speed. Sir, I know that well enough.

Val. What dost thou know?

Speed. That shee is not so faire, as (of you) well-fa-
uour'd?

Val. I meane that her beauty is exquisite,
But her fauour infinite.

Speed. That's because the one is painted, and the o-
ther out of all count.

Val. How painted? and how out of count?

Speed. Marry sir, so painted to make her faire, that no
man counts of her beauty:

Val. How esteem'st thou me? I see mine of her beauty.

Speed. You neuer saw her since she was design'd.

Val. How long hath shee beene before I'd?

Speed. Euer since you lea'd her.

Val. I haue lea'd her euer since I saw her,
And still I see her beautiful.

Speed. If you loue her, you shall see her.

Val. Why?

Speed. Because Loue is blinde: O that you had mine
eyes, or your owne eyes had the lights they were wont
to haue, when you chidde at Sir *Protheus*, for going vn-
garter'd.

Val. What should I see then?

Speed. Your owne present folly, and her passing de-
formitie: for hee being in loue, could not see to garter
his hose; and you, being in loue, cannot see to see on
your hose.

Val. Belike (boy) then you are in loue, for last mor-
You could not see to wipe my shoos.

Speed. True sir: I was in loue with my bed, I thank
you, you swing'd me for my loue, which makes mee the
bolder

holder to chide you, for yours.

Val. In conclusion, I stand affected to her.
Speed. I would you were set, so your affection would cease.

Val. Last night she enjoin'd me,
 To write some lines to one she loveth.

Speed. And have you?

Val. I have.

Speed. Are they not lamely writ?

Val. No (Boy) but as well as I can do them.

Pease. Here she comes.

Speed. Oh excellent motion; oh exceeding Puppet:
 Now will he interpret to her.

Val. Madam & Mistress, a thousand good-morrrows.

Speed. Oh, 'give ye good-morrrows': here's a million of

Val. Sir *Valentine* and servant, to you two thousand.

Speed. He should give her interest & she gives it him.

Val. As you introyd me: I have writ your Letter

Vnto the secret, namelie friend of yours:

Which I was much unwilling to proceed in.

But for my duty to your Ladieship. (done.)

Sil. I thanke you (gentle Servant) 'tis very Clerkly.

Val. Now trust me (Madam) it came hardly-off:

For being ignorant to whom it goes,

I writ at random, very doubtfully.

Sil. Perchance you think too much of so much pains?

Val. No (Madam) soe freed you I will write

(Please you commaund) a thousand times as much:

And yet—

Sil. A pretty period; well; I ghesse the sequell;

And yet I will not name it and yet I care not.

And yet, take this againe: and yet I thanke you:

Meaning henceforth to trouble you no more.

Speed. And yet you will: and yet, another yet.

Val. What meanes your Ladieship?

Do you not like it?

Sil. Yes, yes: the lines are very quaintly writ,

But (since unwillingly) take them againe.

Nay, take them.

Val. Madam, they are for you.

Sil. I, I: you writ them Sir at my request,

But I will none of them: they are for you:

I would have had them writ more movingly:

Val. Please you, I'll write your Ladieship another.

Sil. And when it's writ: for my sake read it over,

And if it please you, so: if not: why so?

Val. If it please me, (Madam) what then?

Sil. Why if it please you, take it for your labour:

And so good-morrow Servant. *Exit Sil.*

Speed. Oh! left valence: inferrible; inisifible;

As a nole on a man's face, or a Wethercocke on a steeple:

My Master sues to her: and she hath taught her Tutor,

He being her Pupill, to become her Tutor.

Oh excellent deuise, was there euer heard a better?

That my master being scribe,

To himselfe should write the Letter?

Val. How now Sir?

What are you reasoning with your selfe?

Speed. Nay: I was timing: 'tis you & haue the reason.

Val. To doe what?

Speed. To be a Spoke-man from Madam *Silvia*.

Val. To whom?

Speed. To your selfe: why, she woes you by a figure.

Val. What figure?

Speed. By a Letter, I should say.

Val. Why she hath not writ to me?

Speed. What need she,

When shee hath made you write to your selfe?

Why, doe you not perceiue the first?

Val. No, beleue me.

Speed. No beleueing you indeede fir:

But did you perceiue her earnest?

Val. She gaue me none, except an angry word.

Speed. Why she hath giuen you a Letter.

Val. That's the Letter I writ to her friend.

Speed. And y^e letter hath she deliuer'd, & there an end.

Val. I would it were no worke.

Speed. He warrant you, 'tis as well:

For often haue you writ to her: and she in modesty,

Or else for want of idle time, could not againe reply,

Or fearing els some messenges, y^e might her mind discouer

Her self hath taught her Loue himselfe, to write vnto her

All this I like in print, for in print I found it. (lower)

Why muse you sir, 'tis dinner time.

Val. I haue dyn'd.

Speed. I, but hearken fir: though the Cameleon Loue

can feed on the ayre, I am one that am nourish'd by my

victoals: and would faine haue meate: oh bee not like

your Mistresse, be moued, be moued. *Exit.*

Scena secunda.

Enter Prothens, Julia, Panthion.

Pro. Haue patience, gentle *Julia*:

Jul. I must where is port remedy.

Pro. When possibly I can, I will returne.

Jul. If you come not: you will returne the sooner?

Keepe this remembrance for thy *Julia*'s sake.

Pro. Why then wee'll make exchange;

Here, take you this.

Jul. And seale the bargain with a holy kisse.

Pro. Here is my hand, for my true conuallence:

And when that bowre ore-slips me in the day,

Wherein I sigh not (*Julia*) for thy sake,

The next ensuing howre, some foule mischance

Torment me for my Loues forgetfulness:

My father staies my coming: and were not:

The tide is now; nay, not thy tide of teares,

That tide will stay me longer then I should,

Julia, farewell: what, gon without a word?

I, so true loue should doe: it cannot speake,

For truth hath better deeds, then words to grace it.

Panth. Sir *Prothens*: you are staid for.

Pro. Goe: I come, I come:

Alas, this parting strikes poore Louers dumbe. *Exit.*

Scena Tertia.

Enter Lauce, Panthion.

Lauce. Nay, 'twill bee this howre ere I haue done

weeping: all the kinde of the *Lauces*, haue this very

fault: I haue recei'd my proportion, like the prodigious

sonne,

Sonne, and am going with Sir *Probus* to the Imperial Court : I thinke *Crab* my dog, be the lowest natured dogge that liues : My Mother weeping : my Father wailing : my Sister crying : our Maid howling : our Catter wringing her hands, and all our house in a great perplexitie, yet did not this cruell-hearted Curte shedde one teare : he is a stone, a very pibble stone, and has no more pity in him then a dogge : I lew would haue wept to haue scene our parting : why my Grahdam hauing no eyes, looke you, wept her selfe blinde at my parting : nay, I shew you the manner of it : This shooe is my father : no, this left shooe is my father ; no, no, this left shooe is my mother : nay, that cannot bee so neither : yes ; it is so, it is so : it hath the worser sole : this shooe with the hole in it, is my mistresse : and this my father : a vengeance on't, there tis : Now fir, this staffe is my sister : for, looke you, tis as white as a lilly, and as small as a wand : this hat is *Nan* our maid : I am the dogge : no, the dogge is himselfe, and I am the dogge : oh, the dogge is me, and I am my selfe : I : so, so : now come I to my Father : Father, your blessing : now should not the shooe speake a word for weeping : now should I thinke my Father : well, hee weepes on : Now come I to my Mother : Oh that she could speake now, like a would-woman : well, I kisse her : why there 'tis : here's my mothers breath up and downe : Now come I to my sister : make the moane she makes : now the dogge all this while sheds not a teare : nor speakes a word : but see how I lay the dust with my teares.

Parth. *Launce*, away, away : a Boord : thy Master is ship'd, and thou art to post after with oares : what's the matter ? why weep'st thou man ? away afe, you'l loofe the Tide, if you tarry any longer.

Launc. It is no matter if the tide were lost, for it is the vnkindest Tide, that euer any man tide.

Parth. What's the vnkindest tide ?

Launc. Why, he that's a tide here, *Crab* my dog.

Parth. Tut, man : I meane thou'lt loofe the flood, and in loofing the flood, loofe thy voyage, and in loofing thy voyage, loofe thy Master, and in loofing thy Master, loofe thy seruice, and in loofing thy seruice : — why dost thou stop my mouth ?

Launc. For feare thou shouldst loofe thy tongue.

Parth. Where should I loofe my tongue ?

Launc. In thy Talle.

Parth. In thy Talle.

Launc. Loofe the Tide, and the voyage, and the Master, and the Seruice, and the tide : why man, if the Riuer were drie, I am able to fill it with my teares : if the winde were downe, I could driue the boate with my fighes.

Parth. Come, come away man : I was sent to call thee.

Launc. Sir : call me what thou dar'st.

Parth. Wilt thou goe ?

Launc. Well, I will goe.

Scena Quarta.

Enter *Valentine*, *Silvia*, *Thurio*, *Speed*, *Duke*, *Probus*.

Sil. Seruant, bid my lord and my lady.

Val. Mistress.

Spee. Master, Sir *Thurio* frownes on you.

Val. I Boy, it's for loue.

Spee. Not of you.

Val. Of my Mistresse then.

Spee. Twere good you knockt him.

Sil. Seruant, you are fad.

Val. Indeed, Madam, I seeme so.

Thw. Seeme you that you are not ?

Val. Haply I doe.

Thw. So doe Counterfeits.

Val. So doe you.

Thw. What seeme I that I am not ?

Val. Wife.

Thw. What instance of the contrary ?

Val. Your folly.

Thw. And how quate you my folly ?

Val. I quate it in your Ierkin.

Thw. My Ierkin is a doublet.

Val. Well then, it's double your folly.

Thw. How ?

Sil. What angry, Sir *Thurio*, do you change colour ?

Val. Giue him leaue, Madam, he is a kind of *Camelion*.

Thw. That hath more minde to feed on your blood,

then lue in your ayre.

Val. You haue said Sir.

Thw. I Sir, and done too for this time.

Val. I know it wel fir, you alwaies end ere you begin.

Sil. A fine volly of words, gentlemē, & quickly shot off.

Val. 'Tis indeed, Madam, we thank the giuer.

Sil. Who is that Seruant ?

Val. Your selfe (sweet Lady) for you gaue the fire,

Sir *Thurio* borrowes his wit from your Ladships looker,

And spends what he borrowes kindly in your company.

Thw. Sir, if you spend word for word with me, I shall

make your wit bankrupt.

Val. I know it wel fir : you haue an Exchequer of

And I thinke, no other treasure to giue your followers :

For it appeares by their bare Lueries

That they liue by your bare words.

Sil. No more, gentlemen, no more :

Here comes my father.

Duk. Now, daughter *Silvia*, you are hard beset.

Sir *Valentine*, your father is in good health,

What say you to a Letter from your friends

Of much good newes ?

Val. My Lord, I will be thankful,

To any happy messenger from thence.

Duk. Know ye *Don Antonio*, your Countiman ?

Val. I, my good Lord, I know the Gentleman

To be of worth, and worthy estimation,

And not without desert so well reputed.

Duk. Hath he not a Sonne ?

Val. I, my good Lord, a Son, that well deserves

The honor, and regard of such a father.

Duk. You know him well ?

Val. I knew him as my selfe : for from our Infancie

We haue consurt, and spent our howres together,

And though my selfe haue bene an idle Trewant,

Omitting the sweet benefit of time

To cloath mine age with Angel-like perfection :

Yet hath Sir *Probus* (for that's his name)

Made vice, and faire aduantage of his daies :

His yeares but young, but his experience old :

His head vn-mellowed, but his Iudgement ripe ;

And in a word (for far behinde his worth

Comes all the praises that I now bestow.)

He is compleat in feature, and in minde,
With all good grace, to grace a Gentleman.

Duk. Beshrew me fir, but if he make this good
He is as worthy for an Emperesse loue,
As meet to be an Emperours Counsellor;
Well, Sir: this Gentleman is come to me
With Commendation from great Potentates,
And heere he means to spend his time a while,
I thinke 'tis no vn-welcome newes to you.

Val. Should I haue wish'd a thing, it had bene he.

Duk. Welcome him then according to his worth:

Solus. I speake to you, and you Sir *Thurio*,
For *Valentius*, I need not cite him to it,
I will send him hither to you presently.

Val. This is the Gentleman I told your Ladiship
Had come along with me, but that his Mistresse
Did hold his eyes, lockt in her Christall looks.

Sil. Be-like that now hee hath enfranchis'd them
Vpon some other pawne for fealty.

Val. Nay sure, I thinke she holds them prisoners still.

Sil. Nay then he should be blind, and being blind
How could he see his way to feeke out you?

Val. Why Lady, Loue hath twenty paire of eyes.

Thur. They say that Loue hath not an eye at all.

Val. To see such Louers, *Thurio*, as you selfe,
Vpon a homely obiect, Loue can winke.

Sil. Haue done, haue done: here comes a Gentleman.

Val. Welcome, deere *Protheus*: Mistresse, I beseech you
Confirm his welcome, with some speciall fauor.

Sil. His worth is warrant for his welcome hether,
If this be he you oft haue wish'd to heare from.

Val. Mistresse, 'tis: sweet Lady, entertaine him
To be my fellow-servant to your Ladiship.

Sil. Too low a Mistresse for so high a seruant.

Pro. Not so, sweet Lady, but too meane a seruant
To haue a look of such a worthy a Mistresse.

Val. Leane off discourse of disabillitie:
Sweet Lady, entertaine him for your Seruant.

Pro. My dutie will I boast of, nothing else.

Sil. And dutie neuer yet did want his meed.

Servant, you are welcome to a worthwhile Mistresse.

Pro. Ile die on him that saies so but your selfe.

Sil. That you are welcome:

Pro. That you are worthwhile: (you.)

Thur. Madam, my Lord your father would speak with

Sil. I wait vpon his pleasure: Come Sir *Thurio*,

Goe with me: once more, new Seruant welcome;

Ile leane you to confer of home affaires,

When you haue done, we looke too heare from you.

Pro. Wee'll both attend vpon your Ladiship.

Val. Now tell me: how do al from whence you came?

Pro. Your friends are well, & haue the much commended.

Val. And how doe yours?

Pro. I left them all in health.

Val. How does your Lady? & how thrines your loue?

Pro. My tales of Loue were wont to weary you,

I know you ioy not in a Loue-discourse.

Val. I *Protheus*, but that life is alter'd now,

I haue done penance for contemning Loue,

Whose high imperious thoughts haue punish'd me

With bitter fasts, with penitentiall grones,

With nightly teares, and daily hart-fore sighes,

For in reuenge of my contempt of loue,

Loue hath chas'd sleepe from my enthral'd eyes,

And made them watchers of mine owne hearts sorrow.

O gentle *Protheus*, Loue's a mighty Lord,

And hath so humbled me, as I confesse
There is no woe to his correction,
Nor to his Service, no such ioy on earth:
Now, no discourse, except it be of loue:
Now can I breake my fast, dine, sup, and sleepe,
Vpon the very naked name of Loue.

Pro. Enough; I read your fortune in your eye:
Was this the Idoll, that you worship so?

Val. Euen She; and is she not a heavenly Saint?

Pro. No; But she is an earthly Paragon.

Val. Call her diuine.

Pro. I will not flatter her.

Val. O flatter me: for Loue delights in praises.

Pro. When I was sick, you gaue me bitter pills,

And I must minister the like to you.

Val. Then speake the truth by her; if not diuine,

Yet let her be a principallitie,

Soueraigne to all the Creatures on the earth.

Pro. Except my Mistresse.

Val. Sweet: except not any,

Except thou wilt except against my Loue.

Pro. Haue I not reason to preter mine owne?

Val. And I will help thee to prefer her to a Mistresse.

Shee shall be dignified with this high honour,

To beare my Ladies traine, left the base earth

Should from her vesture chance to steale a kisse,

And of so great a fauor growing proud,

Disdaine to roote the Sommer-twelling flowre,

And make rough winter euerslastingly.

Pro. Why *Valentine*, what Braggad-sme is this?

Val. Pardon me (*Protheus*) all I can is nothing,

To her, whose worth, make other worthies nothing;

Shee is alone.

Pro. Then let her alone.

Val. Not for the world: why man, she is mine owne,

And I as rich in hauing such a Jewell

As twenty Seas, if all their sand were peayles,

The water, Nestar, and the Rocks pure gold,

Forgiue me, that I doe not dreame on thee,

Because thou seest me doate vpon my loue:

My foolish Riuall that her Father likes

(Onely for his possessions are so huge):

Is gone with her along, and I must after;

For Loue (thou know'st) is full of ielousie.)

Pro. But she loues you?

Val. I, and we are betroath'd: nay more, our marriage

With all the cunning manner of our flight

Determin'd of: how I must climbe her window,

The Ladder made of Cords, and all the means

Plotted, and agreed on for my happinesse,

Good *Protheus* goe with me to my chamber,

In these affaires to aid me with thy counsailes.

Pro. Goe on before: I shall enquire you forth:

I must vnto the Road, to dis-embarque

Some necessities, that I needs must vse,

And then Ile presently attend you.

Val. Will you make haste?

Pro. I will.

Euen as one heate, another heate expels,

Or as one nail, by strength drives out another,

So the remembrance of my former Loue

Is by a newer obiect quite forgotten,

It is mine, or *Valentines* praise?

Her true perfection, or my false transgression?

That makes me reasonlesse, to reason thus?

Shee is faire: and so is *Julia* that I loue,

(That

(That I did love, for now my love is thus, which
Which like waxen image, against a flint, is now
Bears no impression of the thing it was.)
Me think my valente *Valentine* is cold,
And that I love him not as I was wont to do.
O, but I thought his lady too good much for
And that's the reason I thought him so little.
How shall I doate on her with more aduice,
That thus without aduice begin to love her?
Tis but her picture I have yet beheld,
And that hath dazzled my reason's light.
But when I looke on her person,
There is no reason, but I shall be blinde.
If I can check my carrying love, I will
If not, to compass her, I will use my skill.

Scene Quinta.

Enter Speed and Launce.

Speed. *Launce*, by mine honesty welcome to *Padua*.
Launce. Four were not thy selfe, sweet youth, for I am
not welcome. I reckon this alwaies, that a man is neuer
vndon till hee be hang'd, nor neuer welcome to a place,
till some certaine shor be paid, and the Hostesse lay wel-
come.

Speed. Come on you mad-cap: Ile to the Ale-house
with you presently; where, for one shote of five pence,
thou shalt haue five thousand welcomes: But first, how
did thy Master part with *Madam Julia*?

Launce. Marry after they clos'd in earnest, they parted
very fairely in jest.

Speed. But shall he marry him?

Launce. No.

Speed. How then? shall he marry her?

Launce. No, neither.

Speed. What are they broken?

Launce. No; they are both as whole as a fish.

Speed. Why then, how stands the matter with them?

Launce. Marry thus, when it stands well with him, it
stands well with her.

Speed. What an ass art thou, I vnderstand thee not.

Launce. What a blocke art thou, that thou canst not
My staffe vnderstands me better.

Speed. What thou saist?

Launce. I and what I doo: looke they like but leane,
and my staffe vnderstands me better.

Speed. It stands vnder thee indeed.

Launce. Why, stand vnder, and vnderstand is all one.

Speed. But tell me true, wilt be a match?

Launce. Aske my doggie, if he say I, will I; hee say
no, it will: if hee shake his taile, and say nothing, it
will.

Speed. The conclusion is then, that it will.

Launce. Thou shalt neuer geefe such a secret from me, but
by a parable.

Speed. 'Tis well that I get to for but *Launce*, howe saist
thou that that my master is become a notable Louer?

Launce. I neuer knew him otherwise.

Speed. Then how?

Launce. A notable Lubber: as thou reportedst that he
bee.

Speed. Why, thou whoreson Ass, thou mistak'st me.

Launce. Why Foole, I meant not thee, I meant thy
Master.

Speed. It tell thee, my Master is become a hot Louer.

Launce. Why, I tell thee, I care not, though hee burne
himselfe in Loue. If thou wilt goe with me to the Ale-
house: if not, thou art as fit to be a Jew, and not worth
the name of a Christian.

Speed. Why?

Launce. Because thou hast not so much charity in thee as
to goe to the Ale with a Christian. Wilt thou goe?

Speed. At thy seruice.

Scene Sexta.

Enter Proteus alone.

Proteus. To leaue my *Julia*, shall I be forsworne?

To loue faire *Silua*; shall I be forsworne?

To wrong my friend, I shall be much forsworne.

And ev'n that Power which gaue me this oath,

Prouokes me to this three-fold periuire.

Loue bad mee sweare, and Loue bids me for-sweare;

O sweet-suggesting Loue, if thou hast bid,

Teach me (thy stamp'd subiect) to excuse it.

At first I did adore a twinkling Starre,

But now I worship a celestiall Sunne.

Vn-hogd full vowes may headfully be broken,

And he wants wit, that wants resolu'd will.

To learne his wit, I exchange the bad for better.

Fie, fi, vnto end tongue, to call her bad,

Whose souerignty to oft thou hast preferred.

With twenty thousand soules confirming oaths,

I cannot leaue to loue; and yet I doe.

But there I leaue to loue, where I should leaue.

Julia I leaue, and *Valentine* I loose.

If I keepe them, I loose much loose my selfe.

If I loose them, thus kinde I by their losse.

For *Valentine*, my selfe: for *Julia*, *Silua*.

I to my selfe am deerer then a friend.

For Loue is still most precious in it selfe.

And *Silua* (windest heauen that made her faire)

Shewes *Julia* but a swarthy Ethiopie.

I will forget that *Julia* is aliue.

Remembering that my Loue to her is dead.

And *Valentine* he hold an Enemy.

Ayming at *Silua* as a sweeter friend.

I cannot now pectue constant to my selfe.

Without some treachery vs'd to *Valentine*.

This night he meaneth with a Corded-ladder

To climbe celestiall *Silua's* chamber window.

My selfe incontinuaile his competitor.

Now presently Ile giue her father notice

Of their disguising and pretended flight.

Who (all intrag'd) will banish *Valentine*.

For *Thurio* he intends shall wed his daughter.

But *Valentine* being gon, he quickly crosse

By some trickerie, blurt *Thurio's* dull proceeding.

Loue lend me wings, to make my purpose swift.

As thou hast lent me wit, to plot this drift.

Scena septima.

Enter Julia and Lucetta.

Jul. Comforte, *Lucetta*, gentle gentle with me
And eu'n in kinde loue, I doe comfort thee,
Who art the Table wherein all my thoughts
Are visibly Character'd, and expound'd,
To lesson me, and tell me some good meane
How with my honour I may vndertake
A journey to my louing *Protheus*.

Luc. Alas, the way is wearisome and long.
Jul. A true-debuted Pilgrimage is not weary
To measure Kingdomes with his feeble steps,
Much lesse shall he that hath Loues wings to flie,
And when the flight is made to one so deere,
Of such diuine perfection as *Sir Protheus*.

Luc. Better forbear, till *Protheus* make returne.
Jul. Oh, know'st thou not, his looks are my soules food?
Pitty the death that I haue pined in,
By longing for that food for long a time,
Didst thou but know the tiny tooth of Loue,
Thou wouldst as soone goe kinde fire with floures
As seeke to quench the fire of Loue with words.

Luc. I doe not seeke to quench your Loues hot fire,
But qualifie the fires extreme rage,
Left it should burne about the boundes of reason.

Jul. The more thou dost it vp, the more it burneth.
The Current that with gentle murmure glides
(Thou know'st) being stop'd, impatiently doth rage;
But when his faire course is not hindered,
He makes sweet musicke with his enamell'd stones,
Giving a gentle kisse to every sedge
He ouer-takes in his pilgrimage.

And so by many winding nookes he strays
With willing sport to the wilde Ocean.
Then let me goe, and hinder not my course;
Ile be as patient as a gentle sheepee,
And make a pasture of each weedy step,
Till the last sheepee hath brought me to my Loues sheepfold.
And there Ile rest, as after much tannouge,
A blessed soule doth in *Elizium*.

Luc. But in what habite will you goe alone?
Jul. Not like a woman; for I would present
The loose encounters of lasciuious men.

Gentle *Lucetta*, fit me with such weedes as beget life.
As may become some well-repaued Page.

Luc. Why then your Ladship must dye your haire.

Jul. No girle, Ile knit it vp in silken strings.
With twentie old-conceited true-love knots
I To be fantastique, may become a youth.

Of greater time then I shall leue to becom an adge (chere)
Luc. What fashion (Madam) shall I make your bree?

Jul. That fits as well, as tell me good my Lord.

What compass will you weare your Ruffingale?

Why eu'n what fashion thou best likest (*Lucetta*).

Luc. You must needs haue the with a cod-piece (*Ma*)
Jul. Out, out (*Lucetta*) that will be illfauour'd (*Ma*)

Luc. A round hose (*Madam*) now's not worth a pin
Vnlesse you haue a cod-piece to stick pins on.

Jul. *Lucetta*, as thou lo'v'st me let me haue
What thou thinkest meet, and is most manly.

But tell me (wench) how will the world repute me
For vnder-taking so vnstaid a iourney?

I feare me it will misse me scandalous.

Luc. If you thinke so, then stay at home, and goe not.

Jul. Nay, that I will not, and so I will requi

Luc. Then aduee dreame of tofomy, but goe

If *Protheus* like your iourney, when you come,

No matter who's displeas'd, when you are gone.

I feare me he will feare be pleas'd withall.

Jul. That is the least (*Lucetta*) of my feare.

A thousand onethings, as Ocean of his teares,

And instances of infinite of Loue,

Warrant me welcome to my *Protheus*.

Luc. All these are seruants to deceitfull men.

Jul. Bafe men, that vie them to so bafe effect.

But truer starres did gouerne *Protheus* birth,

His words are boilds, his oathes are bracles,

His loue sincere, his thoughts immaculate,

His teares, pure messengers, sent from his heart,

His heart, as far from fraud, as heauen from earth.

Luc. Pray hea'n he prove so when you come to him.

Jul. Now, as thou lo'v'st me, do him not that wrong,

To beare a hard opinion of his truth:

Onely deserue my loue, by louing him,

And presently goe with me to my chamber

To take a note of what I stand in need of,

To furnish me vpon my longing iourney:

All that is mine I leaue at thy dispose.

My goods, my Land, my reparation,

Onely in lieu thereof, dispatch me hence.

Come, I will nere not i but to i presently,

I am impatient of my tarriance.

Exit.

Actus Tertius, Scena Prima.

Enter Duke, Thurio, Protheus, Valentine,

and Launce, Speed.

Duke. Sir *Thurio*, giue vs leaue (I pray) a while,
We haue some secrets to confer about.

Now tell me *Protheus*, what's your will with me?

Pro. My gracious Lord, that which I would discover,
The Law of friendship bids me to conceale.

But when I call to mind your gracious fauours
Done to me (vnderferuing as I am)

My dutie pricks me on to vtter that
Which else, no worldly good should draw from me.

Know (worthy Prince) Sir *Valentine* my friend,
This night intends to steale away your daughter.

My selfe am one made priuy to the plot.

I know you haue determin'd to bestow her
On *Thurio*, whom your gentle daughter hates.

And should she thus bestow away from you,
It would be much vexation to your age.

Thus (for my duties sake) I rather chose
To crosse my friend in his intended drift.

Then (by concealing it) heap on your head
A pack of sorrowes, which would presse you downe.

(Being vnpresented) to your timelesse gauer.

Duke. *Protheus*, I thank thee for thine honest care,
Which to requite, commaund me while I liue.

This loue of theirs, my selfe haue often seene;
Haply when they haue iudg'd me fast asleepe.

And oftentimes haue purpos'd to forbid

Sir

Sir *Valentine* her companion, and my Court.
But fearing lest my jealous yme might erre,
And so (vnworthily) disgrace the man
(A rashness that I euer yet haue shun'd)
I gaue him gentle lookes, thereby to finde
That which chy selfe hath now disclos'd to me.
And that this maist perceiue my feare of this
Knowing that tender youth is soone suggested,
I nightly lodge her in an vpper Towre,
The key whereof, my selfe haue euer kept:
And thence she cannot be convey'd away.

Pro. Know (noble Lord) they haue deuiz'd a meane
How he her chamber-window will ascend,
And with a Corded-ladder fetch her downe:
For which, the youthfull Louer now is gone,
And this way comes he with it presently.
Where (if it please you) you may intercept him.
But (good my Lord) doe it to cunningly
That my discouery be not aimed at:
For, loue of you, not hate vnto my friend,
Hath made me publisher of this pretence.

Duke. Vpon mine Honor, he shall neuer know
That I had any sight from thee of this.

Pro. Adieu, my Lord, Sir *Valentine* is coming.

Duke. Sir *Valentine*, whether away to fath?

Val. Please it your Grace, there is a Messenger
That stays to beare my Letters to my friends,
And I am going to deliuer them.

Duke. Be they of much import?

Val. The teature of them doth but signifie
My health, and happy being at your Court.

Duke. Nay then no matter: stay with me a while,
I am to breake with thee of some affaires
That touch me nere: wherein thou must be secret.
'Tis not vnknewen to thee, that I haue thought
To match my friend Sir *Thurio*, to my daughter.

Val. I know it well (my Lord) and sure the Match
Were rich and honourable: besides, the gentleman
Is full of Vertue, Bounty, Worth, and Qualities
Beleeeming such a Wife, as your faire daughter:
Cannot your Grace win her to fancie him?

Duke. No, trust me, she is peeuish, sullen, froward,
Prowd, disobedient, stubborne, lacking duty,
Neither regarding that she is my childe,
Nor fearing me, as if I were her father:
And may I say to thee, this pride of hers
(Vpon aduice) hath drawne my loue from her,
And where I thought the remnant of mine age
Should haue bene cherish'd by her child-like dutie,
I now am full resolu'd to take a wife,

And turne her out, to who will take her in:
Then let her beauty be her wedding dowrie:
For me, and my possessions she esteemes not.

Val. What would your Grace haue me to do in this?

Duke. There is a Lady in *France* heere
Whom I affect: but she is nice, and coy,
And naught esteemes my aged eloquence.
Now therefore would I haue thee to my Tutor
(For long agoe I haue forgot to court.)
Besides the fashion of the time is chang'd)
How, and which way I may bestow my selfe
To be regarded in her sun-bright eye.

Val. Win her with gifts, if she respect not words,
Dumbe Jewels often in their silent kinde
More then quicke words, doe moue a woman's minde.

Duke. But she did scorne a present that I sent her,

Val. A woman sometime scorns what best contents her,
Send her another: neuer giue her ore,
For scorne at first, makes after-love the more.
If she doe frowne, 'tis not in hate of you,
But rather to beget more loue in you.
If she doe chide, 'tis not to haue you gone,
For why, the fooles are mad, if left alone,
Take no repulie, what euer she doth say,
For, get you gon, she doth not meane away.
Flatter, and praise, commend, extoll their graces:
Though nere so blacke, say they haue Angells faces,
That man that hath a tongue, I say is no man,
If with his tongue he cannot win a woman.

Duke. But she I meane, is promis'd by her friends
Vnto a youthfull Gentleman of worth,
And kept seuerely from resort of men,
That no man hath access by day to her.

Val. Why then I would resort to her by night.

Duke. I, but the doores be lockt, and keyes kept safe,
That no man hath recourse to her by night.

Val. What lets but one may enter at her window?

Duke. Her chamber is aloft, far from the ground,
And built so sheluing, that one cannot climbe it
Without apparant hazard of his life.

Val. Why then a Ladder quaintly made of Cords
To crie vp, with a paire of anchoring bookes,
Would serue to scale another *Hero's* towre,
So bold *Leander* would adventure it.

Duke. Now as thou art a Gentleman of blood
Aduise me, where I may haue such a Ladder.

Val. When would you vse it? pray first tell me that.

Duke. This very night: for Loue is like a childe
That longs for euerie thing that he can come by.

Val. By leauen a clocke, let get you such a Ladder.

Duke. But harke thee: I will goe to her alone,
How shall I best conuey the Ladder thither?

Val. It will be light (my Lord) that you may beare it
Vnder a cloake, that is of any length.

Duke. A cloake as long as thine will serue the turtle?

Val. I my good Lord.

Duke. Then let me see thy cloake,
He get me one of such another length.

Val. Why any cloake will serue the turn (my Lord)

Duke. How shall I fashion me to weare a cloake?

I pray thee let me see thy cloake vpon me.
What Letter is this fane? what's here? to *Salinia*?

And heere an Engine fit for my proceeding,
He be so bold to breake the seals for once.

*My thoughts do harbour with my *Salinia* nightly,
And flares they are to me, that send them strong.
Oh, could their Master come, and goe as lightly,
Himselfe would lodge where (since) they are lying.
My Herald Thoughts, in thy pure bosome rest them,
While I (thee King) that shaker them importune
Doe curse the grace that with such grace hath blest them,
Because my selfe doe want my seruants fortune.*

I curse my selfe, for they are sent by me,

That they should harbour where their Lord should be.

What's here? *Salinia*, this night I will enfranchise thee.

'Tis so: and heere's the Ladder for the purpose.

Why *Pharos* (for thou art *Misery's* sonne)

Wilt thou aspire to guide the heavenly Car?

And with thy darling folly burne the world?

Wilt thou reach stars, because they shine on thee?

Goe base Intruder, ouer-weening Slaue,
Bestow thy fawning smiles on equall mates,
And thinke my patience, (more then thy desert)
Is priuiledge for thy departure hence.
Thanke me for this, more then for all the fauours
Which (all too-much) I haue bestowed on thee.
But if thou linger in thy Territories
Longer then swiftest expedition
Will giue thee time to leaue our royall Court,
By heauen, my wrath shall farre exceed the loue
I crie for my daughter, or thy selfe.
Be gone, I will not heare thy vaine excuse,
But as thou lou'st thy life, make speed from hence.

Val. And why not death, rather then liuing torment?
To die, is to be banisht from my selfe,
And *Silvia* is my selfe: banish'd from her
Is selfe from selfe. A deadly banishment:
What light, is light, if *Silvia* be not seene?
What ioy is ioy, if *Silvia* be not by?
Vnlesse it be to thinke that she is by
And feed vpon the shadow of perfection.
Except I be by *Silvia* in the night,
There is no musicke in the Nightingale.
Vnlesse I looke on *Silvia* in the day,
There is no day for me to looke vpon.
Shee is my essence, and I leaue to be;
If I be not by her faire influence
Foster'd, illumin'd, cherish'd, kept aliue.
I bite not death, to flie his deadly doome,
Tarry I heere, I but attend on death,
But flie I hence, I flie away from life.

Pro. Run (boy) run, run, and seeke him out,
Law. So-hough, So-hough ———
Pro. What seest thou?
Law. Him we goe to finde,
There's not a haire on's head, but 'tis a *Valentine*.

Pro. *Valentine*?
Val. No.
Pro. Who ches? his Spirit?
Val. Neither.
Pro. What then?
Val. Nothing.
Law. Can nothing speake? Master, shall I strike?
Pro. Who wouldst thou strike?
Law. Nothing.
Pro. Villaine, forbear.
Law. Why Sir, Ile strike nothing: I pray you.
Pro. Sirha, I say forbear: friend *Valentine*, a word.
Val. My eares are stop't, & cannot hear good newes,
So much of bad already hath posselt them.

Pro. Then in dumbe silence will I bury mine,
For they are harsh, vn-tuneable, and bad.
Val. Is *Silvia* dead?
Pro. No, *Valentine*.
Val. No *Valentine* indeed, for facted *Silvia*,
Hath shee forsworne me?
Pro. No, *Valentine*.
Val. No *Valentine*, if *Silvia* haue forsworne me,
What is your newes?
Law. Sir, there is a proclamation, if you are vanisht,
Pro. That thou art banish'd: oh that's the newes,
From hence, from *Silvia*, and from me thy friend.
Val. Oh, I haue fed vpon this woe already,
And now excess of it will make me surfer.
Doth *Silvia* know that I am banish'd?
Pro. I, I: and she hath offered to the doome

(Which vn-reuert stands in effectuall force)
A Sea of melting pearle, which some call teares;
Those at her fathers charlish feete the tender,
With them vpon her knees, her humble selfe,
Wringing her hands, whose whitenes so became them,
As if but now they waxed pale for woe:
But neither bended knees, pure hands held vp,
Sad sighes, deepe groanes, nor siluer-shedding teares
Could penetrate her vncompassionate Sire;
But *Valentine*, if he be tane, must die,
Besides, her intercession chaf'd him so,
When she for thy repeale was suppliant,
That to close prison he commanded her,
With many bitter threats of biding there.

Val. No more: vntill the next word that thou speak'st
Haue some malignant power vpon my life:
If so: I pray thee breath it in mine eare,
As ending Anthem of my endlesse dolor.

Pro. Cease to lament for that thou canst not helpe,
And study helpe for that which thou lament'st.
Time is the Nurse, and breeder of all good;
Here, if thou stay, thou canst not see thy loue:
Besides, thy staying will abridge thy life:
Hope is a louters staffe, walke hence with that
And manage it, against despairing thoughts:
Thy letters may be here, though thou art hence,
Which, being writ to me, shall be deliuer'd
Euen in the milke-white bosome of thy Loue.
The time now serues not to exposulate,
Come, Ile conuey thee through the City-gate,
And ere I part with thee, confer at large
Of all that may concerne thy Loue-affaires:
As thou lou'st *Silvia* (though not for thy selfe)
Regard thy danger, and along with me.

Val. I pray thee *Lawrence*, and if thou seest my Boy
Bid him make haste, and meet me at the North-gate.

Pro. Goe Sirha, finde him out: Come *Valentine*.
Val. Oh my deere *Silvia*, haplesse *Valentine*.

Lawrence. I am but a foole, looke you, and yet I haue
the wit to thinke my Master is a kinde of a knaue: but
that's all one, if he be but one knaue: He liues not now
that knowes me to be in loue, yet I am in loue, but a
Term of horse shall not placke that from me: nor who
'tis I loue: and yet 'tis a woman; but what woman, I
will not tell my selfe: and yet 'tis a Milke-maid: yet 'tis
not a maid: for shee hath had Gossips: yet 'tis a maid,
for she is her Masters maid, and serues for wages. Shee
hath more qualities then a Water-Spannell, which is
much in a bare Churlian: Heere is the Cate-log of her
Condition. *Inprimis*, Shee can fetch and carry: why
a horse can doe no more; nay, a horse cannot fetch, but
onely carry, therefore is shee better then a Jade. *Item*.
Shee can milke, looke you, a sweet vertue in a maid with
cleane hands.

Speed. How now Signior *Lawrence*? what newes with
your Master ship?

La. With my Master ship? why, it is at Sea:
Sp. Well, your old vice still: mislaide the word: what
newes then in your paper?

La. The black'st newes that euer thou heard'st.
Sp. Whyman? how blacke?

La. Why, as blacke as Inke.

Sp. Let me read thee?

La. Fie on thee Iolt-head, thou canst not read.

Sp. Thoulyst: I can.

La. I will try thee: tell me this: who begot thee?

Sp. Marry,

Sp. Marry, the son of my Grand-father.
 La. Oh illiterate logger: it was the sonne of thy Grand-mother: this proves that thou canst not read.
 Sp. Come foole, come: try me in thy paper.
 La. There: and S. Nicholas be thy speed.
 Sp. Inprimis she can milke.
 La. I that she can.
 Sp. Item, she brewes good Ale.
 La. And thereof comes the proverbe: (*Blessing of your heart, you brew good Ale.*)
 Sp. Item, she can sewe.
 La. That's as much as to say (*Cousin?*)
 Sp. Item she can knit.
 La. What neede a man care for a flock with a wench, When she can knit him a stocke?
 Sp. Item, she can wash and scoure.
 La. A speciall vertue: for then shee neede not be wash'd, and scow'r'd.
 Sp. Item, she can spin.
 La. Then may I set the world on wheelers, when she can spin for her living.
 Sp. Item, she hath many namelesse vertues.
 La. That's as much as to say *flouard-verrier*: that indeede know not their fathers: and therefore have no names.
 Sp. Here follow her vices.
 La. Close at the heeles of her vertues.
 Sp. Item, shee is not to be falling in respect of her breath.
 La. Well: that fault may be mended with a break-fast: read on.
 Sp. Item, she hath a sweet mouth.
 La. That makes amends for her foure breath.
 Sp. Item, she doth talke in her sleepe.
 La. It's no matter for that: so shee sleepe not in her talke.
 Sp. Item, she is slow in words.
 La. Oh villaine, that set this downe among her vices; To be slow in words, is a womans onely vertue: I pray thee out with't, and place it for her chiefe vertue.
 Sp. Item, she is proud.
 La. Out with that too:
 It was *Enu* legacie, and cannot be t'ane from her.
 Sp. Item, she hath no teeth.
 La. I care not for that neither: because I loue crusts.
 Sp. Item, she is curst.
 La. Well: the best is, she hath no teeth to bite.
 Sp. Item, she will often praise her liquor.
 La. If her liquor be good, she shall: if she will not, I will; for good things should be praised.
 Sp. Item, she is too liberal.
 La. Of her tongue she cannot: for that's writt downe she is flow'ry: of her purse, shee shall not, for that hee keepe shut: Now, of another thing shee may, and that cannot I helpe. Well, proceede.
 Sp. Item, shee hath more haire, then wit, and more faults then haire, and more wealth then faults.
 La. Scap thee: He haue her: she was mine, and not mine, twice or thrise in that last Article: rehearse it thus once more.
 Sp. Item, she hath more haire then wit.
 La. More haire then wit: it may be he prove it: The cover of the salt, hides the salt, and therefore it is more then the salt: the haire that covers the wit, is more then the wit: for the greater hides the lesse: What's next?

Sp. And more faults then haire.
 La. That's monstrous: oh that that were out.
 Sp. And more wealth then faults.
 La. Why that word makes the faults gracious: Well, he haue her: and if it be a match, as nothing is impossible.
 Sp. What then?
 La. Why then, will I tell thee, that thy Master staies for thee at the North gate.
 Sp. For me?
 La. For thee? I, who art thou? he hath staied for a better man then thee.
 Sp. And must I goe to him?
 La. Thou must run to him; for thou hast staied so long, that going will scarce serue the turne.
 Sp. Why didst not tell me sooner? 'pox of your love Letters.
 La. Now will he be fwing'd for reading my Letter; An vnmanly flauie, that will thrust himselfe into secret: He after, to reioyce in the boyes correction. *Exeunt.*

Scena Secunda.

Enter Duke, Thurio, Proteus.

Du. Sir Thurio, feare not, but that she will loue you: Now *Valentine* is banish'd from her sight.
 Th. Since his exile she hath despis'd me most, Forsworne my company, and rail'd at me, That I am desperate of obtaining her.
 Du. This weake impress of Loue, is as a figure Trenched in ice, which with an houres heate Dissolues to water, and doth loose his forme. A little time will melt her frozen thoughts, And worthelesse *Valentine* shall be forgot.
 Du. How now sir *Proteus*, is your countymen (According to our Proclamation) gone?
 Pro. Gon, my good Lord.
 Du. My daughter takes his going grieuouly?
 Pro. A little time (my Lord) will kill that griefe.
 Du. So I beleue: but *Thurio* thinks not so:
Proteus, the good conceit I hold of thee, (For thou hast shewne some signe of good desert) Makes me the better to confer with thee.
 Pro. Longer then I proue loyal to your Grace, Let me not line, to looke vpon your Grace.
 Du. Thou know'st how willingly I would effect The match betwene sir *Thurio*, and my daughter:
 Pro. I doe my Lord.
 Du. And alio, I thinke, thou art not ignorant How she opposes her against my will?
 Pro. She did my Lord, when *Valentine* was here.
 Du. I, and peruersly, the persecutors so: What might we doe to make the girl forget The loue of *Valentine*, and loue sir *Thurio*?
 Pro. The best way is to slander *Valentine*, With falsehood, cowardize, and poore dilcent:
 Three things, that women highly hold in hate.
 Du. I, but she'll thinke, that it is spoke in hate.
 Pro. I, if his enemy deliuet it.
 Therefore it must with circumstance be spoken By one, whom she esteemeth as his friend.
 Du. Then you must undertake to slander him.

Pro.

Pro. And that (my Lord) I shall be loath to doe:
'Tis an ill office for a Gentleman,
Especially against his very friend.

Du. Where your good word cannot advantage him,
Your slander neuer can euasinate him;
Therefore the office is indifferent,
Being intreated to it by your friend.

Pro. You haue prevail'd (my Lord) if I can doe it
By ought that I can speake in his dispraise,
She shall not long continue loue to him;
But say this wee'de her loue from *Valentine*,
It folloes not that she will loue fir *Thurio*.

Th. Therefore, as you vniwinde her loue from him;
Least it should rouse, and be good to none,
You must prouide to bottome it on me:
Which must be done, by praising me as much
As you, in worth dispraise, fir *Valentine*.

Du. And *Prothens*, we dare trust you in this kinde,
Because we know (on *Valentines* report)
You are already loues firme votary,
And cannot soone reuoke, and change your minde.
Vpon this warrant, shall you haue access,
Where you, with *Silue*, may sonner set at large.
For she is lumpish, heavy, mellancholly,
And (for your friends sake) will be glad of you;
Where you may temper her, by your perswasion,
To hate yong *Valentine*, and loue my friend.

Pro. As much as I can doe, I will effect:
But you fir *Thurio*, are not thirpe desires:
You must lay lime, to tangle her desires
By walfull Sonnets, whose compos'd Rimes
Should be full fraught with seruiceable verses.

Du. I much is the force of beauen-bred Poesie.

Pro. Say that vpon the altar of her beauty
You sacrifice your teares, your sighes, your heart:
Write till your inke be dry; and with your teares
Mouit it againe: and frame some feeling line,
That may discouer such integrity:
For *Orpheus* liue, was strung with Poets sinewes,
Whose golden touch could soften Steele and stones;
Make Tygers tame, and huge *Centaurians*
Forsooke vsuou'ded detepes, to dance on Sands.
After yong dis-lamenting Elegies,
Visit by night your Ladies chamber-window
With some sweet Comfort: To their Instruments
Tune a deploing dumps: the nights dead silence
Will well become such sweet complaining grievance:
This, or else nothing, will inherite her.

Du. This discipline, shewes thou hast bin in loue.

Th. And thy aduise, this night, ile put in practise:
Therefore, sweet *Prothens*, my direction-giner,
Let vs into the City presently
To force some Gentleman, well skill'd in Musicke.
I haue a Spinner, that will loose the turne
To giue the counter to my good aduise.

Du. About it Gentleman.

Pro. We'll wait vpon your Grace, till after Supper,
And afterward determine our proceedings.

Du. Euen now about it, I will pardon you. *Exeunt.*

Actus Quartus. Scena Prima.

Enter Valentine, Speed, and certaine Court-ladies.

1. Owl. Fellowes, stand fast: I fee a passenger.

2. Owl. If there be ten, shrinke not, but down with 'em.

3. Owl. Stand fir, and throw vs that you haue about ye.
If not: we'll make you fir, and ristle you.

Sp. Sir we are vndone: these are the Villaines
That all the Trauailers doe feare so much.

Val. My friends.

1. Owl. That's not so, fir: we are your enemies.

2. Owl. Peace: we'll heare him.

3. Owl. I by my beard will we: for he is a proper man.

Val. Then know that I haue little wealth to loofe;
A man I am, cros'd with aduerstie:

My riches, are these poore habiliments,
Of which, if you should here disfurinish me,
You take the sum and substance that I haue.

2. Owl. Whether trauell you?

Val. To *Perma*.

1. Owl. Whence came you?

Val. From *Milawe*.

3. Owl. Haue you long sojourn'd there?

Val. Some sixteen moneths, and longer might haue
If crooked fortune had not thwarted me.

1. Owl. What, were you banish'd thence?

Val. I was.

2. Owl. For what offence?

Val. For that which now torments me to rehearse;
I kill'd a man, whose death I much repent,
But yet I slew him manfully, in fight,
Without false vantage, or base treachery.

1. Owl. Why nere repent it if it were done so;
But were you banish'd for so small a fault?

Val. I was, and held me glad of such a doome.

2. Owl. Haue you the Tongues?

Val. My youthfull traualle, therein made me happy,
Or else I often had beene often miserable.

3. Owl. By the bare scalpe of *Robin Hood* fat Fryer,
This fellow were a King, for our wilde faction.

1. Owl. We'll haue him: Sirs, a word.

Sp. Master, be one of them:

It's an honourable kinde of theievery.

Val. Peace villaine.

2. Owl. Tell vs this: haue you any thing to take to?

Val. Nothing but my fortune.

3. Owl. Know then, that some of vs are Gentlemen,
Such as the fury of vngouern'd youth
Thrust from the company of awfull men,
My selfe was from *Verona* banish'd,
For practising to steale away a Lady,
And heire and Neece, aside vnto the Duke.

2. Owl. And I from *Mantua* for a Gentleman,
Who in my mood, I stab'd vnto the heart.

1. Owl. And I, for such like petty crimes as these,
But to the purpose: for we cite our faults,
That they may hold excus'd our lawlesse liues;
And partly seeing you are beautifide
With goodly shape; and by your owne report,
A Linguist, and a man of such perfection,
As we doe in our quality much want.

2. Owl. Indeede because you are a banish'd man,
Therefore, about the rest, we parley to you:
Are you content to be our Generall?
To make a vertue of necessity,
And liue as we doe in this wilderness?

3. Owl. What faist thou wilt thou be of our consort?
Say I, and be the captain of vs all:
We'll doe thee homage, and be rul'd by thee,
Loue thee, as our Commander, and our King.

1. Owl.

Pro. I likewise heare that *Valentine* is dead.
Sil. And so suppose am I; for in her graue
 Affure thy selfe, my loue is buried.
Pro. Sweet Lady, let me take it from the earth.
Sil. Goe to thy Ladies graue and call hers thence,
 Or at the least, in hers, sepulcher thine.

Int. He heard not that.
Pro. Madam: if your heart be so obdurate:
 Vouchsafe me yet your Picture for my loue,
 The Picture that is hanging in your chamber:
 To that it speake, to that it sigh and weep:
 For since the substance of your perfect selfe
 Is else deuoted, I am but a shadow;
 And to your shadow, will I make true love.

Int. If 'twere a substance you would fure deuide it;
 And make it but a shadow, as I am.
Sil. I am very loath to be your Idoll Sir;
 But, since your falsehood shall become you well,
 To worship shadowes, and adore false shapes,
 Send to me in the morning, and ile send it.
 And so, good rest.

Pro. As wretches haue one night's blow
 That wait for execution in the morne.
Int. He'll, will you goe?
Ho. By my hallidome, I was fast asleep.
Int. Pray you, where lies Sir *Prothemus*?
Ho. Marry, at my house.
 Trust me, I thinke 'tis almost day.
Int. Not so; but it hath bin the longest night
 That ere I watch'd, and the most beautifull.

Vpon whose faith and honor, I repose:
 Vrge not my fathers anger (*Eglamoure*)
 But thinke vpon my griefe (a Ladies griefe)
 And on the iustice of my flying hence,
 To keepe me from a moit vnholly match
 Which heauen and fortune fill rewards with plagues,
 I doe desire thee, euen from a heart
 As full of sorrowes, as the Sea of sande
 To beare me company, and goe with me
 If not, to hide what I haue said to thee,
 That I may venture to depart alone.

Egl. Madam, I pittie much your grieuances,
 Which, since I know they virtuously are plac'd,
 I glue consent to goe along with you,
 Wreaking as little what besideth me,
 As much, I with all good besortune you.
 When will you goe?

Sil. This euening coming.
Eg. Where shall I meete you?
Sil. At *Frier Patrickes* Cell,
 Where I intend holy Confession.
Eg. I will not faile your Ladiship:
 Good morrow (gentle Lady).

Sil. Good morrow, kinde Sir *Eglamoure*.

Scena Quarta.

Enter Louce, Prothemus, Silvia, and a Cur.

Lou. When a mans seruant shall play the Cur with
 him (looke you) it goes hard: one that I brought vp of
 a puppy: one that I sau'd from drowning, when three or
 foure of his blinde brothers and sisters went to it: I haue
 taught him (euen as one would say precisely, thus I
 would teach a dog) I was sent to deliuer him, as a pre-
 sent to Mistress *Silvia*, from my Master; and I came no
 looner into the dying-chamber, but he steps me to her
 Trencher, and heales her Capons-leg: O, 'tis a foule
 thing, when a Cur cannot keepe himselfe in all compa-
 nies: I would haue (as one should say) one that takes vp
 on him to be a dog indeede, to be, as it were, a dog at all
 things. If I had not had more wit then he, to take a fault
 vpon me that he did, I thinke verily hee had bin hang'd
 for't: for as I liue he had suffer'd for't: you shall iudge:
 Hee thrusts me himselfe into the company of three or
 foure gentleman-like-dogs, vnder the Dukes table: hee
 had not bin there (blessed he marke) a pissing while; but
 all the chamber smelt him: out with the dog (saies one)
 what cur is that (saies another) whip him out (saies the
 third) hang him vp (saies the Duke.) I hauing bin ac-
 quainted with the smell before, knew it was Crab; and
 goes me to the fellow that whips the dogges: stand
 (quoth I) you meane to whip the dog: I marry doe I
 (quoth he) you doe him the more wrong (quoth I) 'twas
 I did the thing you wot of: he makes me more adoe,
 but whips me out of the chamber: how many Masters
 would doe this for his Seruant? nay, ile be sworne I haue
 far in the stocks, for puddings he hath stolne, otherwise
 he had bin executed: I haue stood on the Pillorie for
 Geefe he hath kil'd, otherwise he had suffer'd for't: thou
 thinke 'it not of this now: nay, I remember the tricke you
 seru'd me, when I tooke my leaue of Madam *Silvia*: did

Scena Tertia.

Enter Eglamoure, Silvia.
Eg. This is the house that Madam *Silvia*
 Entreated me to call, and know her minde:
 Ther's some great matter she'd employ me in,
 Madam, Madam.

Sil. Who calls?
Eg. Your seruant, and your friend:
 One that attends your Ladiships command.

Sil. Sir *Eglamoure*, a thousand times good morrow.
Eg. As many (worthy Lady) to your selfe:
 According to your Ladiships impose,
 I am thus early come, to know what seruice
 It is your pleasure to command me in.

Sil. Oh *Eglamoure*, thou art a Gentleman:
 I thinke not 't better (for I sweare I doe not)
 Valliant, wise, remorsefull, well accomplish'd,
 Thou art not ignorant what deere good will
 I beare vnto the banish'd *Valentine*:
 Nor how my father would enforce me marry
 Vaine *Thurio* (whom my very soule abhor'd):
 Thy selfe hast lov'd, and I haue heard thee say:
 No griefe did euer come so neere thy heart
 As when thy Lady and thy true loue did:
 Vpon whose Graue thou vow'dst pure chastitie:
 Sir *Eglamoure*: I would to *Prothemus*
 And to *Madama*, where I heare, he makes adoe:
 For the waies are dangerous to passe:
 I doe desire thy worthy company,

not I bid thee still marke me, and doe as I do; when did'st thou see me heau'p my leg; and make water against a Gentlewoman's fartingale? did'st thou euer see me doe such a trick?

Pro. *Sebastian* is thy name: I like thee well, And will employ thee in some seruice presently.

In. In what you please, sir, doe what I can.

Pro. I hope thou wilt. How now you whose-son pezant, Where haue you bin these two dayes loytering?

La. Marry Sir, I carried Mistis *Silvia* the dogge you bad me.

Pro. And what saies she to my little Tewell?

La. Marry she saies your dog was a cur, and tels you currish thanks is good enough for such a present.

Pro. But she receiue'd my dog?

La. No iudeede did she not:

Here haue I broughed him backe againe.

Pro. What didst thou offer her this from me?

La. I Sir, the other Squirrell was stolne from me By the Hangmans boyes in the market place, And then I offer'd her mine owne, who is a dog As big as ten of yours; & therefore the giust the greater.

Pro. Goe, gett thee hence, and finde my dog againe, Or nere returne againe into my sight.

Away, I say: stayest thou to vex me here; A Slave, that shall an end, turnes me to shame:

Sebastian, I haue entertained thee, Partly that I haue neede of such a youth,

That can with some discretion doe my businesse: For 'tis no trusting to yond foolish Lowt;

But chiefly, for thy face, and thy behauiour, Which (if my Augury deceiue me not)

Witnesse good bringing vp, fortune, and truth: Therefore know thee, for this I entertaine thee,

Go presently, and take this Ring with thee, Deliu' it to Madam *Silvia*;

She lou'd me well, deliu' it to me.

In. It seemes you lou'd not her, not leaue her token: She is dead belike?

Pro. Not so: I thinke she liues.

In. Alas.

Pro. Why do'st thou cry alas?

In. I cannot chooseth me pitty her.

Pro. Wherefore should'st thou pitty her?

In. Because, methinks that she lou'd you as well

As you doe loue your Lady *Silvia*:

She dreames on him, that has forgot her loue,

You doate on her, that cares not for your loue.

'Tis pitty Loue, should be so contrary:

And thinking on it, makes me cry alas.

Pro. Well: giue her that Ring, and therewithall

This Letter: that's her chamber: Tell my Lady,

I claime the promise for her beauenly Picture:

Your message done, hye home vnto my chamber,

Where thou shalt finde me sad, and solitarie.

In. How many women would doe such a message?

Alas poore *Prothacio*, thou hast entertain'd

A Foxe, to be the Shepheard of thy Lambs;

Alas, poore foole, why doe I pitty him

That with his very heart despiseth me?

Because he loues her, he despiseth me,

Because I loue him, I must pitty him.

This Ring I gaue him, when he parted from me,

To binde him to remember my good will:

And now am I (vnhappy Messenger)

To plead for that, which I would not obtaine;

To carry that, which I would haue refus'd;

To praise his faith, which I would haue disprais'd.

I am my Masters true confum'd Loue,

But cannot be true seruant to my Master,

Vnlesse I proue false traitor to my selfe.

Yet will I woe for him, but yet so coldly,

As (beauen it knowes) I would not haue him speed.

Gentlewoman, good day: I pray you be my meane

To bring me where to speake with Madam *Silvia*.

Sil. What would you wish her, if that I be she?

In. If you be she, I doe intreat your patience

To heare me speake the message I am sent on.

Sil. From whom?

In. From my Master, Sir *Prothacio*, Madam.

Sil. Oh: he sends you for a Picture?

In. I, Madam.

Sil. *Prothacio*, bring my Picture there,

Goe, giue your Master this: tell him from me,

One *Silvia*, that his changing thoughts forget

Would better sit his Chamber, then this Shadow.

In. Madam, please you peruse this Letter;

Pardon me (Madam) I haue vnadu'is'd

Deliu'ed you a paper that I should not;

This is the Letter to your Ladiship.

Sil. I pray thee let me looke on that againe.

In. It may not be: good Madam pardon me.

Sil. There, hold:

I will not looke vpon your Masters lines:

I know they are stuff with protestations,

And full of new-found oarhes, which he will breake

As easily as I doe teare his paper.

In. Madam, he sends your Ladiship this Ring.

Sil. The more shame for him, that he sends it me;

For I haue heard him say a thousand times,

His *Silvia* gaue it him, at his departure:

Though his false finger haue prophand'd the Ring,

Mine shall not doe his *Silvia* so much wrong.

In. She thanks you.

Sil. What said'st thou?

In. I thank you Madam, that you tender her:

Poore Gentlewoman, my Master wrongs her much.

Sil. Do'st thou know her?

In. Almost as well as I doe know my selfe.

To thinke vpon her woes, I doe proteit

That I haue wept a hundred seuerall times.

Sil. Belike she thinks that *Prothacio* hath forsook her?

In. I thinke she doth: and that's her cause of sorrow.

Sil. Is she not passing faire?

In. She hath bin fairer (Madam) then she is.

When she did thinke my Master lou'd her well;

She, in my iudgement, was as faire as you.

But since she did neglect her looking-glasse,

And threw her Sun-expelling Masque away,

The ayre hath staru'd the roses in her cheekes,

And pinch'd the lilly-tincture of her face,

That now she is become as blacke as I.

Sil. How tall was she?

In. About my stature: for at *Pentecost*,

When all our Pageants of delight were plaid,

Our youth got me to play the womans part,

And I was trim'd in Madams *Silvia* gowne,

Which seru'd me as fit, by all mens iudgements,

As if the garment had bin made for me:

Therefore I know she is about my height,

And at that time I made her weepe a good,

For I did play a lamentable part.
(Madam) 'twas *Ariadne*, passioning
For *Theseus* periury, and vntrist flight;
Which I so liuely acted with my teares:
That my poore Mistris moued therewithall,
Wept bitterly: and would I might be dead,
If I in thought felt not her very sorrow.

Sil. She is beholding to thee (gentle youth)
Alas (poore Lady) desolate, and left;
I weepe my selfe to thinke vpon thy words:
Here youth: there is my purple; I giue thee this (well,
For thy sweet Mistris sake, because thou lou'st her. Fare-

Int. And she shall thank you for't, if ere you know
A virtuous gentlewoman, milde, and beautifull. (het.
I hope my Masters suit will be but cold,
Since she respects my Mistris loue so much.
Alas, how loue can trifle with it selfe:
Here is her Picture: let me see, I thinke
If I had such a Tyre, this face of mine
Were full as lowly, as is this of hers;
And yet the Painter flatter'd her a little,
Vnlesse I flatter with my selfe too much.
Her haire is *Auburne*, mine is perfect *Yellow*;
If that be all the difference in his loue,
He get me such a colour'd *Perrywig*:
Her eyes are grey as glasse, and so are mine:
I, but her fore-head's low, and mine's as high:
What should it be that he respects in her,
But I can make respectiue in my selfe:
If this fond Loue, were not a blinded god.
Come shadow, come, and take this shadow vp,
For 'tis thy riuall: O thou fencelesse forme,
Thou shalt be worship'd, kiss'd, lou'd, and ador'd;
And were there fence in his Idolatry,
My substance should be statue in thy stead.
He vie thee kindly, for thy Mistris sake
That vs'd me so: or else by *Ioue*, I vow,
I should haue scratch'd out your vnseeing eyes,
To make my Master out of loue with thee. *Exeunt.*

Actus Quintus. Scena Prima.

Enter Eglamour, Silvia.

Egl. The Sun begins to guild the western skie,
And now it is about the very houre
That *Silvia*, at Fryer *Patrick's* Cell should meet me,
She will not faile; for Louers breake not houes,
Vnlesse it be to come before their time,
So much they spur their expedition.
See where she comes: Lady a happy euening.

Sil. Amen, Amen: got on (good *Eglamour*)
Out at the Posterne by the Abbey wall;
I feare I am attended by some Spies.

Egl. Feare not: the Forest is not three leagues off,
If we recouer that, we are sure enough. *Exeunt.*

Scena Secunda.

Enter Thurio, Proteus, Julia, Duke.

Th. Sir *Proteus*, what saies *Silvia* to my suit?

Pro. Oh Sir, I finde her milder then she was,
And yet she takes exceptions at your person.

Th. What? that my leg is too long?

Pro. No, that it is too little.

Th. He weare a Boote, to make it somewhat round.

Pro. But loue will not be spurd to what it loathes.

Th. What saies she to my face?

Pro. She saies it is a faire one.

Th. Nay then the wanton lyes: my face is blacke!

Pro. But Pearles are faire; and the old saying is,
Blacke men are Pearles, in beauteous Ladies eyes.

Th. 'Tis true, such Pearles as put out Ladies eyes,
For I had rather winke, then looke on them.

Th. How likes she my discourse?

Pro. Ill, when you talke of war.

Th. But well, when I discourse of loue and peace.

Th. But better indeede, when you hold you peace.

Th. What saies she to my valour?

Pro. Oh Sir, she makes no doubt of that.

Th. She needs not, when she knowes it cowardize.

Th. What saies she to my birth?

Pro. That you are well deri'd.

Th. True: from a Gentleman, to a foole.

Th. Considers she my Possessions?

Pro. Oh, I: and pitties them.

Th. Wherefore?

Th. That such an Ass should owe them.

Th. That they are out by Lease.

Th. Here comes the Duke.

Du. How now Sir *Proteus*; how now *Thurio*?

Which of you saw *Eglamour* of late?

Th. Not I.

Pro. Nor I.

Du. Saw you my daughter?

Pro. Neither.

Du. Why then
She's fled vnto that pezzant, *Valentine*;
And *Eglamour* is in her Company:

'Tis true: for Fryer *Laurence* met them both
As he, in pennance wander'd through the Forrest:

Him he knew well: and guess'd that it was she,
But being mask'd, he was not sure of it.

Besides she did intend Confession
At *Patrick's* Cell this euen, and there she was not.

These likelihoods confirme her flight from hence;
Therefore I pray you stand, not to discourse,

But mount you presently, and meete with me
Vpon the rising of the Mountaine foote

That leads toward *Mantua*, whether they are fled:
Dispatch (sweet Gentlemen) and follow me.

Th. Why this it is, to be a peeuish Girle,
That flies her fortune when it follows her:

He after; more to be reueng'd on *Eglamour*,
Then for the loue of reck-lesse *Silvia*.

Pro. And I will follow, more for *Silvia* loue
Then hate of *Eglamour* that goes with her.

Int. And I will follow, more to crosse that loue
Then hate for *Silvia* that is gone for loue. *Exeunt.*

Scena Tertia.

Silvia, On-Lanes.

1. On. Come, come be patient:

We

We must bring you to our Captaine.

Sil. A thousand more mischances then this one
Hauē learn'd me how to bēgoke this patiently.

2 *Out.* Come, bring her away.

1 *Out.* Where is the Gentleman that was with her?

3 *Out.* Being nimble footed, he hath out-run vs.

But *Mysses* and *Valerius* follow him:

Goe thou with her to the West end of the wood,
There is our Captaine: We'll follow him that's fled,
The Thicket is best, he cannot scape.

1 *Out.* Come, I must bring you to our Captaine came.

Feare not: he beares an honourable minde,
And will not vse a woman lawfully.

Sil. O *Valentine*: this I endure for thee.

Exeunt.

SCENA QUARTA.

Enter *Valentine*, *Protheus*, *Silvia*, *Julia*, *Duke*, *Thurio*,
Out-laws.

Val. How we doth breed a habit in a man?

This shadowy desert, vnfrequented woods
I better brooke then flourishing peopled Townes:

Here can I sit alone, vn-scene of any,

And to the Nightingales complaining Notes

Tune my distressed, and record my woes.

O thou that dost inhabit in my breast,

Leaue not the Mansion so long Tenantlesse,

Lest growing ruinous, the building fall,

And leaue no memory of what it was.

Repaire me, with thy presence, *Silvia*:

Thou gentle Nymph, cherish thy for-lorne swaine,

What hallowing, and what stir is this to day?

These are my mates, that make their wills their Law,

Hauē some vnhappy passenger in chace;

They loue me well: yet I haue much to doe

To keepe them from vnliuell outrages.

Withdraw thee *Valentine*: who's this comes heere?

Pro. Madam, this seruice I haue dooe for you

(Though you respect not aught your seruant doth)

To hazard life, and reskew you from him,

That would haue forc'd your honour, and your loue,

Vouchsafe me for my meed, but one faire looke:

(A smaller boone then this I cannot beg,

And lesse then this, I am sure you cannot giue.)

Val. How like a dreame is this? I see, and heare:

Loue, lend me patience to ferbeare a while.

Sil. O miserable, vnhappy that I am,

Pro. Vnhappy were you (Madam) ere I came:

But by my coming, I haue made you happy.

Sil. By thy approach thou mak'st me most vnhappy.

Jul. And me, when he approacheth to your presence.

Sil. Had I bene ceazed by a hungry Lion,

I would haue bene a break-fast to the Beast,

Rather then haue false *Protheus* reskue me:

Oh heauen be iudge how I loue *Valentine*,

Whose life's as tender to me as my soule,

And still as much (for more there cannot be)

I doe detest false periu'd *Protheus*:

Therefore be gone, sollicite me no more.

Pro. What dangerous action, stood it next to death

Would I not vndergoe, for one calme looke:

Oh 'tis the curse in Loue, and still approu'd

When women cannot loue, where they're belou'd.

Sil. When *Protheus* cannot loue, where he's belou'd:

Read ouer *Julia*'s heart, (thy first best Loue)

For whose deare sake, thou didst then rend thy faith

Into a thousand oaths; and all those oaths,

Descended into periuery, to soue me,

Thou hast no faith left now, vnlesse thou'dst two,

And that's false worse then none: better haue none

Then plurall faith, which is too much by one:

Thou Counterfeyt, to thy true fitend.

Pro. In Loue,

Who respects friend?

Sil. All men but *Protheus*.

Pro. Nay, if the gentle spirit of mouing words

Can no way change you to a milder forme—

He wooe you like a Souldier, at armes end,

And loue you 'gainst the nature of Loue: force ye.

Sil. Oh heauen,

Pro. He force thee yeeld to my desire.

Val. Russian: let goe that rude vnliuell touch,

Thou friend of an ill fashion.

Pro. *Valentine*,

Val. Thou common friend, that's without faith or loue,

For such is a friend now: treacherous man,

Thou hast beguill'd my hopes: nought but mine eye

Could haue perfwaded me: now I dare not say

I haue one friend aliue: thou wouldst dispoise me:

Who should be truill'd, when ones right hand

Is periu'd to the bosome? *Protheus*

I am sorry I must neuer trust thee more,

But count the world a stranger for thy sake:

The priuate wound is deepest: oh time, most accurst:

'Moonght all foes that a friend should be the worst!

Pro. My shame and guilt confounds me:

Forgiue me *Valentine*: if heere sorrow

Be a sufficient Ransome for offence,

I tender't heere: I doe as truly suffer,

As ere I did commit.

Val. Then I am paid:

And once againe, I doe receiue thee honest;

Who by Repentance is not satisfied,

Is nor of heauen, nor earth: for these are pless'd:

By Penitence th'Eternalls wrath's appeas'd:

And that my loue may appeare plaine and free,

All that was mine, in *Silvia*, I giue thee.

Jul. Oh me vnhappy.

Pro. Looke to the Boy.

Val. Why, Boy?

Why wast thou now? what's the matter? look vp: speak.

Jul. O good sir, my master charg'd me to deliuer a ring

to Madam *Silvia*: w (out of my neglect) was neuer done.

Pro. Where is that ring? boy?

Jul. Heere 'tis: this is it.

Pro. How? let me see.

Why this is the ring I gaue to *Julia*.

Jul. Oh, cry you mercy sir, I haue mistooke:

This is the ring you sent to *Silvia*.

Pro. But how cam'st thou by this ring? at my depart

I gaue this vnto *Julia*.

Jul. And *Julia* her selfe did giue it me,

And *Julia* her selfe hath brought it hither:

Pro. How? *Julia*?

Jul. Behold her, that gaue ayme to all thy othes,

And entertain'd 'em deeply in her heart.

How oft hast thou with periuery clef't the roote?

Oh *Protheus*, let this habit make thee bluss.

Bethow ashamed that I have took vpon me,
Such an immodest rayment; if shame liue
In a disguise of loue?
Is it the lesser blot modestly findes,
Women to change their shapes, then men their minds.

Pro. Then men their minds; as true as heauen, were man
But Constant he were perfect; that one error
Fits him with fault; makes him run through all th' sins;
Inconstancy falls off, ere it begins:
What is in *Silvia's* face, but I may spie
More fresh in *Julia's*, with a constant eye?

Val. Come, come: a hand from either:
Let me be blest to make this happy close:
'Twere pittie two such friends should be long foes.

Pro. Bease wignes (happen) I haue my wish for euer.

Ind. And I mine.

Out-l. A prizes a prizes a prize.

Val. Forbeare, forbeare I say: it is my Lord the Duke.
Your Grace is welcome to a man disgrac'd,
Banish'd *Valentine*.

Duke. Sir *Valentine*?

Thm. Yonder is *Silvia*: and *Silvia's* mine.

Val. *Thurio* giue backe: or else embrace thy death:
Come not within the measure of my wrath:
Doe not name *Silvia* thine: if once againe,
Verana shall not hold thee: heere the stands,
Take but possession of her, with a Touch,
I dare thee, but to breath vpon my Loue.

Thm. Sir *Valentine*, I care not for her, Is
I hold him but a foole that will endanger
His Body, for a Girl that loues him not:
I claime her not, and therefore she is thine.

Duke. The more degenerate and base art thou
To make such meanes for her, as thou hast done,
And leaue her on such slight conditions.

Now, by the honor of my Ancestry,
I doe applaud thy spirit, *Valentine*,
And thinke thee worthy of an Emperesse loue:
Know then, I heere forget all former grieues,
Cancell all grudge, repeale thee home againe,
Plead a new state in thy vniuald merit,
To which I thus subscribe: Sir *Valentine*,
Thou art a Gentleman, and well deri'd;
Take thou thy *Silvia*, for thou hast deseru'd her.

Val. I thank your Grace, & gift hath made me happy:
I now beseech you (for your daughters sake)
To grant one Boone that I shall aske of you.

Duke. I grant it (for thine owne) what ere it be.

Val. These banish'd men, that I haue kept withall,
Are men endu'd with worthy qualities:
Forgiue them what they haue committed here,
And let them be recall'd from their Exile:

They are reformed, ciuill, full of good,
And fit for great employment (worthy Lord.)

Duke. Thou hast prevail'd, I pardon them and thee:
Dispose of them, as thou knowst their defects.

Come, let vs goe, we will include all isres,
With Triumphs, Mirth, and rare solemnity.

Val. And as we walke along, I dare be bold
With our discourse, to make your Grace to smile.

What thinke you of this Page (my Lord?)

Duke. I thinke the Boy hath grace in him, he blushes.

Val. I warrant you (my Lord) more grace, then Boy.

Duke. What meane you by that saying?

Val. Please you, Ile tell you, as we passe along,
That you will wonder what hath fortun'd:

Come *Protheus*, 'tis your penance, but to heare
The story of your Loues discovered.

That done, our day of marriage shall be yours,
One Feast, one house, one mutuall happinesse. *Exeunt.*

The names of all the Actors.

Duke: Father to *Silvia*.

Valentine. } the two Gentlemen.

Protheus. }

Antiochus: father to *Protheus*.

Thurio: a foolish riuall to *Valentine*.

Eglamour: Agent for *Silvia* in her escape.

Hof: where *Julia* lodges.

Out-lawes with *Valentine*.

Speed: a clownish seruant to *Valentine*.

Launce: the like to *Protheus*.

Panthion: seruant to *Antiochus*.

Julia: beloued of *Protheus*.

Silvia: beloued of *Valentine*.

Lucetta: waiting woman to *Julia*.

FINIS.

THE